WRENFORD BOROUGH COUNCIL

Statement Guide: Incident

Document Guide 05 | Issue 2 | Owner: Street Care Office | Review cycle: every twelve months

1. What this guide covers

This guide covers incident: something that has already happened at the defect - a trip, a fall, a cyclist coming off, a vehicle striking it, a person walking into a branch. It appears in resident descriptions and call notes.

The guide is used by the Street Care Coordinator or Highways Inspector who opens a review - the reviewer in this guide - and by the Highways Inspector who decides it. Whether a requirement is met is a separate question, settled by the report and its defect type's own standard. This guide is about what the documents show: the tools flag only a measurement sentence whose figure differs from the report's or gives a figure the report left blank, as the Report Rules set out, and every other check here is the reviewer's own.

2. How it shows up in a statement

A sentence of this kind usually says one of these:

- a person who tripped or fell, and what happened to them
- a cyclist or a motorcyclist who came off
- a vehicle that struck the defect or the column
- a person who walked into a low branch
- a fall the caller saw or was told of

3. What the reviewer checks

These are the checks the reviewer makes, in this order:

1 Read each sentence of this kind for what happened and to whom.
2 Note every incident for the review's record.
3 Note an incident that happened where the report puts the defect.
4 Weigh the incident in the recommendation without letting it decide a requirement.
5 Note an incident that the inspection should record on site.

4. Requirements it bears on

Incident bears on no requirement: it tells the Highways Inspector that the defect has already hurt someone, and the requirements still decide which decisions are open.

5. When the statement and the report disagree

An incident cannot disagree with a report's answer, because no requirement reads it; where it suggests the defect is worse than the report's figures, the reviewer notes it for the Highways Inspector.

6. What to ask the reporter for

Ask the reporter where exactly the incident happened, and whether it has been reported before.

7. Telling it apart

Something that happened to a person at the defect is an incident; an earlier report or repair at the same place is a previous report, which the Previous Reports guide covers. "A cyclist came off here" is an incident; "this was patched before" is a previous report.